

CHEMEX WEEKEND BREWING NOTES

Fritz Rush | one point of material pride

The rule is Chemex on weekends, Nespresso on weekdays. Weekdays do not deserve the ritual and the ritual does not survive the fellowship rotation. Weekends earn it.

EQUIPMENT

- Chemex six-cup carafe (received as a wedding gift from Diane's grandmother - irreplaceable emotional weight, do not chip)
- Chemex bonded filters (natural, three-fold, always folded to the trisected side against the spout)
- Fellow Stagg EKG gooseneck kettle
- Baratza Encore grinder set to 24 for Chemex (medium-coarse, table salt texture)
- Acaia Pearl scale
- Filtered water only (Britta pitcher on the counter)

BEANS

Weekend rotation, single-origin only. Rotation between:

- Ethiopian Yirgacheffe from Batdorf and Bronson (blueberry, jasmine, tea-like body)
- Colombian Huila from Buford Highway Farmers Market roaster (chocolate, brown sugar)
- Kenyan AA when I can find it (bright citrus, wine-like acidity - hardest to source)
- Guatemala Antigua from Little Tart Bakeshop (chocolate, spice, balanced)

Never blends. Never dark roasts. Never anything more than three weeks off roast.

RATIO

The Chemex ratio is 1:16 by weight. For a two-cup weekend morning that's 30 g of coffee to 480 g of water. For a full carafe weekend brunch that's 50 g of coffee to 800 g of water. Precision matters. This is where physician-scientist and coffee nerd become the same person.

WATER TEMPERATURE

205 degrees Fahrenheit. Kettle set exactly. Off boil for 30 seconds if using lighter roasts (Ethiopian) to avoid over-extraction of the delicate florals.

METHOD

1. Grind 30 g (or 50 g) fresh, right before brewing. Never pre-ground.
2. Rinse the filter with hot water until the filter has no paper taste. Discard the rinse water. Filter should be snug against the Chemex, no air gaps at the thick-fold side.
3. Add ground coffee to the filter. Give the Chemex a gentle shake to level the bed.
4. Bloom pour: add 60 g of water (double the coffee weight) in a spiral, starting from the center, covering all the grounds evenly. Wait 45 seconds. The bed should rise and CO2 should visibly release.
5. Main pour: add water in slow spirals, keeping the water level about halfway

up the Chemex neck. Pour to 240 g total by 1:30. Pour to 360 g total by 2:15.

Pour to 480 g total by 3:00.

6. Total draw-down time should be 4:00 to 4:30 from the start of the bloom.

7. Swirl the Chemex once when done. Discard the filter. Serve.

TASTING NOTES DIARY

Saturday, February 14, 2026 - Ethiopian Yirgacheffe, batch received Feb 7. Bloom smelled like blueberry jam. Cup delivered on the promise - clean, tea-like, honey finish. Diane took a sip and said "this is why we do the weekends".

Saturday, May 30, 2026 - Colombian Huila. Grinder was one setting too fine (23 instead of 24), draw-down went to 5:15, cup was over-extracted. Note to self: check the grinder every batch, it drifts.

Saturday, August 22, 2026 - Kenyan AA, hard to find. Found a bag through the Little Tart barista who had a source. Cup was bright and full, blackcurrant note. Kevin came over that morning for a walk and Diane made him a cup. He said "I understand now" which is the highest compliment Kevin gives on a non-clinical topic.

Saturday, September 26, 2026 - Guatemala Antigua. Balanced. Carter watched the pour and asked why Dad's coffee looks different. Explained the bloom.

SUNDAY MODIFICATION

Sunday morning coffee happens before the 10 AM call to my mother. Which means 5:45 AM after the long-run cool-down. Which means quiet grinder, quiet kettle, one cup only. The full ritual on Saturday, the reduced ritual on Sunday. Both count.

DIANE'S CUP

Diane drinks half a cup, always with a splash of oat milk. She does not care about the beans. She cares about the ritual and about being handed a cup. That is enough.

CARTER'S CUP

Carter gets a "coffee cup" of warm milk with a tiny drop of the finished brew. Enough color to look like the grown-up cup. Zero caffeine impact. He takes it very seriously and this is one of my favorite weekend rituals.

EQUIPMENT NOTES

Replace filters when the last one has been used. Replace grinder burrs at 500 lb of coffee ground (approximately). Replace the Stagg EKG when it dies. The Chemex itself never gets replaced.